

THE BLACK PANTHER

INTERCOMMUNAL NEWS SERVICE

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

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VOL. XVI NO. 29

SATURDAY, JUNE 4, 1977

25¢



Work Or Starve

CARTER PLAN TO CUT MILLIONS OFF WELFARE



Carter's new welfare proposal will serve only to increase the overwhelming hardship faced by Black and poor people by forcing them into menial, low-paying, dead-end jobs.

(Washington, D.C.) - In an outright attack on Black and poor people in this country, the Carter administration announced last week that under the new proposed welfare system millions of people who now receive public assistance will lose most of their aid if they do not accept jobs.

As explained by Secretary of Health, Education and Welfare (HEW) Joseph Califano, unmarried mothers of teenage children would be required to work; a single-parent family of four with one or more young children would receive \$4,200 per year; and a two-parent family of four would receive a maximum of \$2,300 a year — or nothing if one parent would not accept work.

The federally established poverty level for a family of four in the U.S. is currently \$5,500. The U.S. Labor Department, however, disputes this figure, estimating that a "minimum but adequate" budget for a family of four is around \$9,700.

In a related development, Labor Department officials predicted that nearly 100,000 of the government's more than 400,000 new public service jobs will go to welfare mothers. This is particularly significant since a key aspect of the Carter plan is to provide larger cash payments to people who take private employment than those who are federally employed.

Black Michigan Congressman John Conyers, a long-time advocate of full employment and welfare reform, said in attacking Carter's welfare plan, "It reads like an old-fashioned
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